Course Outline Template

Indian Institute of Management Calcutta

Programme :…MBA……   Name of the Course: MANAGING DIGITAL BUSINESSES IN NETWORKED MARKET   Core / Elective …ELECTIVE… No Cap   Credit: 3   Academic Year & Term: …2025-26, Term-VI   Course Coordinator: Abhipsa Pal   **Email:** IIMC id: abhipsapal@iimcal.ac.in
Instructor: …Abhipsa Pal (Sessions 1 – 20)   **Affiliation:** ……IIMC……..   **Email:** IIMC id: abhipsapal@iimcal.ac.in

Introduction to Course /Course Description

This is the age of digitization, resulting in the digital transformation of businesses. Revolutionary advances in information technology and the penetration of the internet have catapulted us into the era of digital businesses, connecting demand-side and customer-side players in unimaginable magnitude and speed. Subsequently, markets have digitalized and the dynamics of IT products and services industries play a critical role. Additionally, the new rules of governance with non-traditional regulations complicate the decision-making in digital business-driven markets.

Course Objective and Key-takeaways from the course

With the networked economy being the future of industrialization, this course aims to discuss the digital businesses, in the following ways:

- equip students on how digital aspects shapes modern-day businesses
- understand the dynamics of these disruptive digital platforms to be better prepared to face the competition
- enable students on the management of IT products including hardware and software
- innovative applications of platforms like sharing economy, crowdsourcing, and social media

These topics offer an understanding of how businesses operate, succeed, and fail, in this heavily digitized ecosystem.

Programme Level Learning Goals (7)

Learning Goals

1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organizational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations

-Learn and apply the latest digital business models while managing an organization

-Understand why a business succeeds or fails using the business models and concepts discussed in the class, and be able to make decisions for an organization accordingly

2. Develop and apply ethical values to analyze and solve organizational problems

-Critically analyze social and ethical challenges faced by platform businesses

-How businesses can face the challenges and find ways of resolution

International Components in your course (if any)
The reference materials include international articles , cases from across the globe (published by international publishers like HBR and Ivey), and news articles with business cases from worldwide.

Pre-requisites
Please list

Required Text Book(s)

Platform Business Models for Executives – R. Srinivasan, 2nd Edition, Springer (2023)

Recommended Text Book(s)

N.A.

Course Pack Distribution to students

Course material (if required) will also be issued from the Programme office

Technology enabled learning component for your course

N.A.

Session Plan

Sr. no./ Session	Topic	Intended learning outcome	References	
Module 1: Overview of Digital Businesses				
1	Overview of digital businesses	-Introduction to digital aspects in businesses	Optimizing Your Digital Business Model By: Peter Weill; Stephanie Woerner	Case: Case: Netflix Inc.: The Disruptor Faces Disruption By: Chris F. Kemerer; Brian Kimball Dunn
2		-Thinking digital for businesses -Rethinking value proposition	Reinventing Your Business Model By: Mark W. Johnson; Clayton M. Christensen; Henning Kagermann Additional: Chapter 6 of The Digital Transformation Playbook	
Module 2: Management of IT Products & Services				
3	IT Products Management	-IT Products Business Model - Innovation by Rapid Experimentation	Chapter 5 of The Digital Transformation Playbook	Case: Kindle Fire: Amazon's Heated Battle for the Tablet Market By: Sawhney; Owens; Goodman
4		-IT Products Market -IT products pricing strategies	Article: A Quick Guide to Value-Based Pricing By: Utpal M. Dholakia, HBR	
5	Software Management	-Software product management -software development -software product pricing	Video: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5RoctT_OdQcA Article: Competing Against Free By: David J. Bryce; Jeffrey H. Dyer; Nile W. Hatch	Group exercise: Ideation of a software product -Why this product? -What kind of development method will you use? -What will be its price? -If you wanted to outsource/offshore, what kind of model would you chose? -Is your product an IP? What kind of licensing would you want?
6		-Software services management -Outsourcing & offshoring models	Tallman, Stephen. "Offshoring, Outsourcing, and Strategy in the Global firm." *AIB Insights* 11.1 (2011): 3. Examples of nearshoring, reshoring, insourcing	
7	IP Management	-Licensing of IP -Open Innovation strategies	Intellectual Property Strategy By: Andy Wu; Aticus Peterson	
Module 3: Digital Marketplace				
8	Digital Marketplace	-Ebusiness models	Article: Shopify is quietly fuelling India's challenger brands. Now, it needs to nurture the ecosystem (Economic Times Article)	Case: Zouk bags Financial Express Article:Bagging limelight: New-age D2C bag brands expand portfolios and retail presence- Written by Vaishnavi Gupta
9		-Businesses thriving in the digital marketplace -Platforms vs sellers	Article: Thriving in an increasingly digital ecosystem. Weill, P., & Woerner, S. L. (2015). HBR	
10	Platform Ecosystem	- How digital platforms are transforming marketplaces -Network effects	Platform Mediated Network: Definitions & Core Concepts. (2006) Thomas R. Eisenmann (HBS Note)	Case: Electronic Arts in Online Gaming Thomas R. Eisenmann; Justin Wong (2004) (HBR Case)
11		-Network Mobilization and Platform Architecture	Class discussion and case	
12		-Interoperability -Dynamics of WTA networked markets	Eisenmann, T. R. (2006). Winner-take-all in networked markets. Evans, D. S., & Schmalensee, R. (2016).	

Module 4: Innovations with Digital Platforms				
13	Sharing Economy Platforms	-Marketplaces evolving on sharing economy platforms	Article: Adapting to the Sharing Economy. Kurt Matzler; Viktoria Veider; Wolfgang Kathan (2015) HBS Video: The Rise of Airbnb: From Airbeds to Billions https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Tc9YScMtN8	Case: Facebook marketplace Article: Facebook to charge sellers using Marketplace. Read where, how much it will cost https://www.livemint.com/technology/facebook-to-charge-sellers-using-marketplace-read-where-how-much-it-will-cost-11636187106139.html
14	Businesses on Social Media Ecosystem	-Social media platforms for business	Article: We're all Connected: The Power of the Social Media Ecosystem Richard C. Hanna; Andrew Rohm; Victoria L. Crittenden (2011)	
15	Crowdsourcing & crowdfunding	- crowdsourcing models -Platforms for crowdfunding	Article: Managing your reputation on the world of crowdsourcing Video: Film: Life In A Day, https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JaFVr_cJJIY&t=379s	
Module 5: Governance and Challenges of Digital Businesses				
16	Digital business governance & sustainability	-Regulatory and governance issues of platforms	Chapter 21 New article: FarmVille is leaving Facebook after more than a decade of letting players harvest crops and raise livestock with friends https://www.businessinsider.in/tech/news/farmville-is-leaving-facebook-after-more-than-a-decade-of-harvesting-crops-and-raising-livestock/articleshow/78370749.cms	
17		-Factors affecting sustainability of digital businesses	Article: Why Some Platforms Thrive and Others Don't News: Google Finally Shuts Down Orkut, Its First Social Network https://www.forbes.com/sites/ellenhuet/2014/06/30/google-kills-orkut/?sh=2a8f68c634b5	
18	Ethics and challenges	-Ethical dilemmas	Video: Why Facebook's Data Scandal is a Big Deal https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a3W1I2_B6GA Video: My Airbnb Got ROBBED! Airbnb Risks and The Host Guarantee Update 2019: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=60sh-Vl3Ypg	
19		-Digital Piracy	The Digital-Piracy Dilemma By: Michael D. Smith; Brett Danaher	
Revision Module: Revision and Project Discussion				
20	Revision	-Revisions of core concepts	Revision using group projects Concepts -Digital marketplaces, network effects, platform strategies, applications, challenges & issues	

Evaluation Components

✓ Components	✓ Weightage
Class participation & assignments	25%
Project	25%
Quizzes	20%
End term	30%

Online Course Management (Moodle)/course web

This outline may be filled after reading the MBA Instructors Manual